AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

SECONDARY SCHOOL CERTIFICATE

CLASS X EXAMINATION

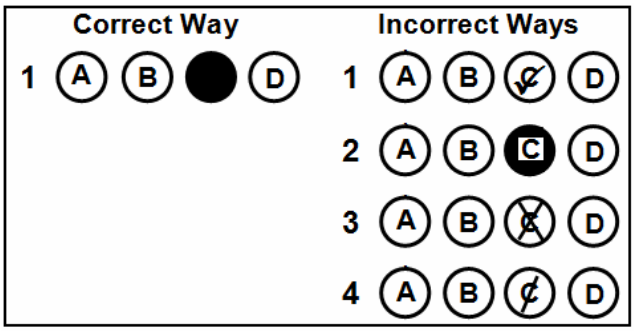
MAY 2014

English Compulsory Paper I

Time: 45 minutes Marks: 25

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Read each question carefully.
2. Answer the questions on the separate answer sheet provided. DO NOT write your answers on the question paper.
3. There are 100 answer numbers on the answer sheet. Use answer numbers 1 to 25 only.
4. In each question there are four choices A, B, C, D. Choose ONE. On the answer grid black out the circle for your choice with a pencil as shown below.



Candidate's Signature

5. If you want to change your answer, ERASE the first answer completely with a rubber, before blacking out a new circle.
6. DO NOT write anything in the answer grid. The computer only records what is in the circles.

Listening Comprehension Section

In this section you will hear two recordings. Each one will be played twice.

Listen carefully to the first recording, and then read the questions. You will have two minutes' reading time.

The recording will then be replayed. You can make notes on your question paper.

When the recording has finished, enter your answers on your separate answer sheet. You will have three and a half minutes to pencil in your answers.

Follow the instruction on the front page of Paper I to show which of the options; A, B, C, or D you have selected for each question.

Listening Passage I

This passage exposes the inner conflict experienced by a press photographer while taking photographs.

Source: 'The Subject Not Photographed' by John Berger and Jean Mohr

Now listen to the recording.

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

1. Which of the following types of storm had compelled the other group of climbers to stay back in the hut?

   A. Snow storm
   B. Sand storm
   C. Thunder storm
   D. Wind storm

2. The climbers from the northern face were exhausted because of the

   A. long route taken by them.
   B. severe weather.
   C. steepness of the summit.
   D. many injuries that they endured.

3. According to the speaker, which of the following actions was more urgent after meeting the other group of climbers?

   A. To reach the summit
   B. To send injured ones home
   C. To capture the photographs of the injured
   D. To take the injured to the foot of the hill

4. Which of the following actions led the speaker to a back operation?

   A. Exposure to severe weather
   B. Taking the injured climbers down on his back
   C. Constantly carrying camera, lenses and films
   D. Capturing the photographs on top of a mountain

5. What was the speaker thinking about while lying on the hospital bed?

   A. The spotless anguish
   B. Taking pictures
   C. The fellow climbers
   D. The hospital’s cleanliness

6. The speaker finally decided that he would

   A. relax for some more time as he liked it.
   B. take pictures of the injured.
   C. not take pictures of the hospital.
   D. lie on his side in future.

Now, we will play the second recording. It will also be played twice.

Listen carefully to the first playing, then read the questions. You will have two minutes' reading time. The recording will then be replayed.

When the recording has finished, enter your answers on your separate answer sheet. You will have three and a half minutes to pencil in your answers.

Listening Passage II

The passage is about the description of the characteristics of an elephant family.

Source: Children's Magazine Times of India

Now listen to the recording.

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

7. An elephant family is led by the

   A. independent females.
   B. youngest female.
   C. strongest female.
   D. eldest female.

8. What is the main aim of the matriarchal society of elephants?

   A. To guide the young ones
   B. To wander on the pastures freely
   C. To keep the males away from the group
   D. To increase the availability of food

9. How many members are there in a basic African elephant family?

   A. 1 to 3
   B. 3 to 6
   C. 6 to 12
   D. 12 to 24

10. Which group do the males join when they grow up?

    A. Bond group
    B. Bull band
    C. Bull clan
    D. Matriarchal group

11. Scientists find it difficult to examine the behaviour of elephants because they

    A. travel across a wide range.
    B. split up into small groups.
    C. live together in unity.
    D. are often killed for their ivory.

12. We can understand from the passage that when faced with adversity

    A. elephants travel through a wide range.
    B. female elephants split up to form sub-groups.
    C. male elephants stay and travel together.
    D. bond groups become clans.

Reading Comprehension Section

You have 20 minutes for this section. This section has two reading passages. You are advised to spend approximately 10 minutes on each of the given passages.
Read the passage carefully and then answer the multiple choice questions that follow:

Reading Passage I

In the beginning, there was an ice-cold current that swept up the west coast of Africa, carrying polar storms and penguins right into the tropics.

It continued for millions of years, unmercifully compelling the climate into shaping a hard, barren, sandy land. For almost 3000 kilometres from Cape Point to the Cunene River, there is now nothing but rocks and dunes, rugged hills and patches of thorny scrub.

This is the Skeleton Coast, whose history is written in its sun-bleached bones. Walk here, as I did as a child, and you can read every line.

In open graves along dry river-beds lie the long limbs of ancient reptiles that once scrambled through the Mesozoic, hissing and snapping at the dark. Half-buried above the high tideline stand cages of ribs which contain the remains of modern whales who found some kind of despair in the deep and tried to hurl themselves back on the land.

Somewhere between the two rests a phenomenon. A prodigy concealed only by the sand and enormous mounds of broken shell.

I was fifteen when I found it. Just a skinny kid, burned dark by the sun, curious and solitary, very happy on my own. I loved that dry country and knew something of the richness in the wrinkles of its skin. I was familiar with the hidden mounds. The fragments of shell shone like beacons, visible from a great distance all along the old raised beaches. But I knew nothing of those who had made them, except that they were sometimes called Strandloopers-Afrikaans for “the beach walkers”.

Then, ankle deep in sand one day, I stubbed my toe, dug down and found a bone. Another tiny fragment in the record of the land, but rather different from the rest. I cleared the area carefully, finding more bones, leaving them in place and keeping on excavating until I had a hole the size of a large suitcase. And in it, the body of a man.

He was small, smaller than I, with a huge head. He lay on his left side in a foetal position, with his knees drawn up and one hand raised to pillow the great dome of the skull. I had been a little afraid when I first realized that the skeleton was human, but all fear disappeared as I exposed the figure fully and could see how frail and vulnerable it was.

Adapted from ‘Early Impressions’ by Lyall Watson

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

13. The environmental change in the west coast of Africa occurred due to

A. massive snowfall.
B. tropical climate.
C. ice-cold currents.
D. dry river-beds.

14. What weather change(s) occurred from Cape Point to Cunene River?

I. Snow kept falling for millions of years.
II. The land became barren.
III. A coastline was formed.

A. I only
B. II only
C. I and III
D. I and II

15. We can infer from the passage that the basic climate of the Skeleton Coast was

A. rugged and cold.
B. sun-bleached.
C. dry and barren.
D. unmerciful.

16. Which of the following is CORRECT?

A. The author discovered the West Coast below Cunene River.
B. Broken shells and rugged hills were covered by live reptiles.
C. Some whales threw themselves at land before dying.
D. Hidden mounds remained undiscovered by the author.

17. What is the meaning of the word ‘prodigy’ as used in line 12?

A. A horrific event
B. An occasional mishap
C. A rare happening
D. A desperate sight

18. Which of the following words does NOT support the physical description of the author at the time of the discovery?

A. Social
B. Thin
C. Adolescent
D. Dark-skinned

19. The first evidence which made the author believe that some ancient people lived on the coast before him was

A. the sight of chewed bones.
B. a stubbed toe.
C. the sight of a human bone.
D. shells broken by children.

Read the passage carefully and then answer the multiple choice questions that follow:

Reading Passage II

From an early age, I spent most of my free time in the field playing and fighting with the other boys of the village. A boy who remained at home tied to his mother's apron strings was regarded as a sissy. At night, I shared my food and blanket with these same boys. I was no more than five when I became a herd-boy, looking after sheep and calves in the fields. I discovered the almost mystical attachment that the Xhosa have for cattle, not only as a source of food and wealth, but as a blessing from God and a source of happiness. It was in the fields that I learned how to knock birds out of the sky with a slingshot, to gather wild honey and fruits and edible roots, to drink warm, sweet milk straight from the udder of a cow, to swim in the clear, cold streams, and to catch fish with twine and sharpened bits of wire. I learned to stick-fight--essential knowledge to any rural African boy and became adept at its various techniques, parrying blows, feinting in one direction and striking in another, breaking away from an opponent with quick footwork. From these days I date my love of the field, of open spaces, the simple beauties of nature, the clean line of the horizon.

As boys, we were mostly left to our own devices. We played with toys we made ourselves. We molded animals and birds out of clay. We made ox-drawn sleighs out of tree branches. Nature was our playground. The hills above Qunu were dotted with large smooth rocks which we transformed into our own roller coaster. We sat on flat stones and slid down the face of the large rocks. We did this until our backsides were so sore we could hardly sit down. I learned to ride by sitting atop weaned calves-- after being thrown to the ground several times, one got the hang of it.

I learned my lesson one day from an unruly donkey. We had been taking turns climbing up and down its back and when my chance came I jumped on and the donkey bolted into a nearby thornbush. It bent its head, trying to unseat me, which it did, but not before the thorns had pricked and scratched my face, embarrassing me in front of my friends. Like the people of the East, Africans have a highly developed sense of dignity, or what the Chinese call "face." I had lost face among my friends. Even though it was a donkey that unseated me, I learned that to humiliate another person is to make him suffer an unnecessarily cruel fate. Even as a boy, I defeated my opponents without dishonoring them.

Adapted from ‘Long Walk to Freedom’ by Nelson Mandela

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

20. The mystical connection the writer discovered as a herd-boy was the association between

A. nature as a source of survival and blessing.
B. games and keeping the tribal traditions.
C. self respect of Xhosa tribe and honour.
D. food and health.

21. What did the boys feel while sliding down the rocks?

A. Happiness
B. Excitement
C. Enthusiasm
D. Pain

22. The word ‘adept’ in line 10 means

A. adaptable.
B. expert.
C. fast.
D. learned.

23. Why did the author say that he had lost face among his friends?

A. He used a Chinese expression.
B. His donkey ride was undignified.
C. His face was injured.
D. He had lost out to a donkey.

24. By saying ‘nature was our playground’ (lines 15-16) the writer means that

A. there was no playground.
B. they made all outdoors a playground.
C. toys were made in the likeness of animals.
D. nature was the source of knowledge.

25. The passage mainly aims to describe

A. games played by village boys.
B. country life in Africa.
C. African sense of dignity.
D. childhood in an African tribe.

END OF PAPER

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